BOOK 2

VIOLIN BEGINNER GUIDE

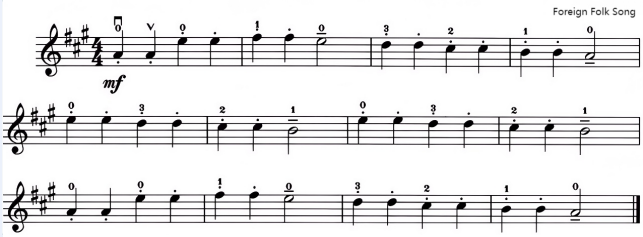
Reading Music and Your First Melody

Learn pitch, note values and symbols, then bring rhythm and A major together in Twinkle.

01 Read pitches, meter and symbols

02 Practice rhythm and A major

03 Bring it together in Twinkle



Featured tune: Twinkle

READ IN ORDER

Begin after Book 1. Book 3 adds D, G and C major, etudes and a practice plan.

Inside this book

Reading Music and Your First Melody

03 **Staff reading and pitch landmarks**

Use the open strings to locate pitches on the staff.

04 **Note values, rests and meter**

Learn durations and the grouping in 4/4 and 3/4.

05 **Bow directions and musical symbols**

Read slurs, ties, dynamics and accidentals.

06 **Rhythm patterns on open strings**

Clap and count, then bow the same rhythm.

07 **Whole steps, half steps and fingers**

Recognize four basic finger-spacing patterns.

08 **A major finger placement**

Prepare each finger while observing the rests.

09 **A major scales, slurs and arpeggios**

Practice the familiar scale in three bowing stages.

10 **Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star**

Combine fingering, rhythm and bow direction.

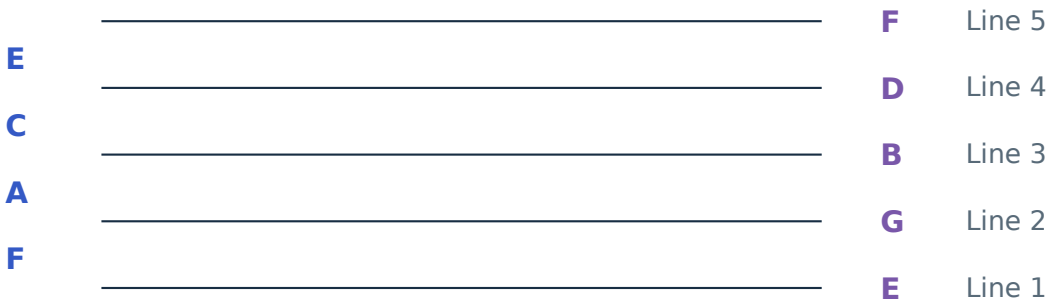
PRACTICE NOTES

Practice order: clap and count first, then add the bow and fingers. Once A major is familiar, try the bowing stages on page 9 and Twinkle on page 10.

Each book is numbered from its cover. Source notes retain the original textbook page numbers.

Find pitches on the staff

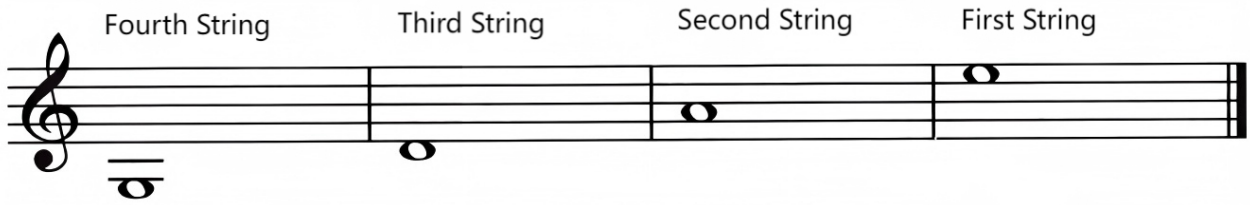
Violin music normally uses treble clef. Count the five lines and four spaces from below.



Spaces: F A C E
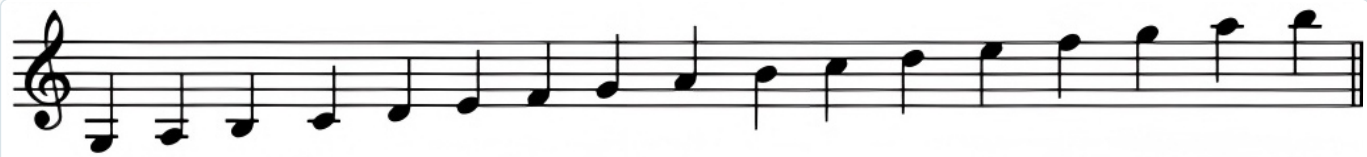
Lines: E G B D F

Use the open strings as landmarks



Open G is below the second lower ledger line. Open D is below line 1; A is in space 2; E is in space 4. Learn these four landmarks first.

Natural notes in first position



Before playing a new line

Check the clef, key signature and time signature. Read the pitch together with any fingering numbers above it.

Source: Original pp. 3, 5-6.

Give notes and rests their full value

Here a quarter note equals one beat. Note values are proportional; the meter groups them into bars.

Note	Name	Value	Count
	Whole note	4 beats	1-2-3-4
	Half note	2 beats	1-2
	Quarter note	1 beat	1
	Eighth note	1/2 beat	2 per beat
	Sixteenth note	1/4 beat	4 per beat

Start with 4/4 and 3/4

Meter	Top number	Bottom number
4/4	Four beats per bar	Quarter note = one beat
3/4	Three beats per bar	Quarter note = one beat

Keep counting through rests

Stay silent during a rest, but keep the pulse. A dot adds half the original note value.

Source: Original pp. 4-5; added counting prompts.

Bow directions, lines and dynamics

Bow direction and dynamics help give the same melody a different shape and character.



Down-bow

Move from the frog toward the tip.



Up-bow

Move from the tip toward the frog.



Slur

Different notes under a slur are normally played in one bow stroke.



Tie

Joins notes of the same pitch; add their durations. Distinguish it from a slur.

Dynamic markings

p	mf	f	cresc.
Soft	Moderately loud	Loud	Gradually louder

Accidental	Meaning
Sharp #	Raises a note by a half step.
Flat b	Lowers a note by a half step.
Natural	Cancels an earlier sharp or flat.
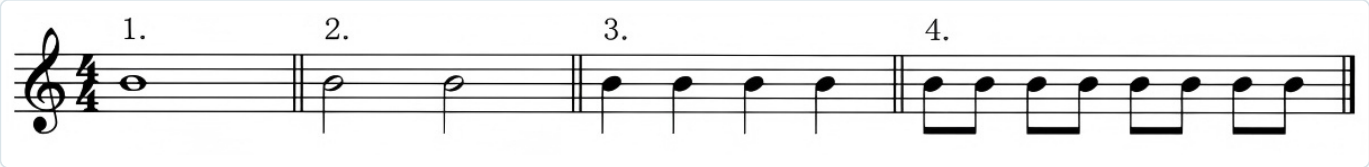
0-4 indicates fingering, not note names. The key signature changes the relevant pitches.

Source: Original pp. 6-9.

Clap it first. Then bow it.
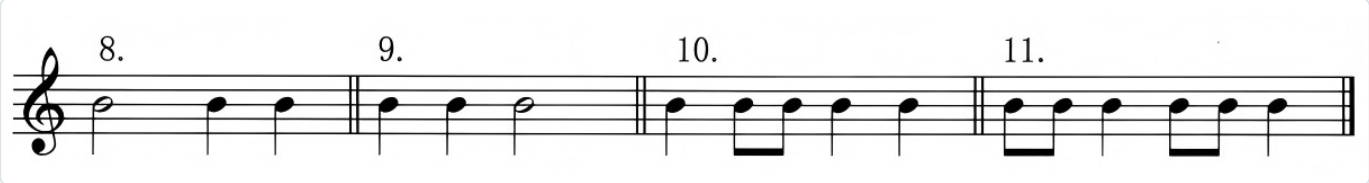
Clap and count the pattern aloud before playing the same rhythm on an open string.

Start with whole, half, quarter and eighth notes



Each exercise is in 4/4. Count a steady 1, 2, 3, 4 and fit the notes to that pulse. Keep counting silently during longer notes.

Mix longer and shorter notes in one bar



1. **Clap and count**

   Leave out pitch for now. Read each rhythm against an even pulse.

2. **Play on an open string**

   Use A, one note per bow. Use less bow for short notes and plan more bow for long ones.

3. **Repeat without stopping**

   Repeat a group four times without extra gaps between bars. Keep every beat the same length.

Ready to move on?

Play both groups while counting. Keep the pulse steady without rushing or adding pauses at bow changes.

Source: Original pp. 18-19; added practice steps.

Whole steps apart, half steps close

The fingers are not evenly spaced. Listen to the pitch and keep a natural hand shape.

0 is an open string; 1-4 are the index through little fingers. The original book groups four common patterns. These diagrams show only the spacing between fingers 1-4.

Fingers 1-2 close

Relative finger spacing



Fingers 2-3 close

Relative finger spacing



Fingers 3-4 close

Relative finger spacing



All whole steps

Relative finger spacing



Begin with close 2-3 on A and E

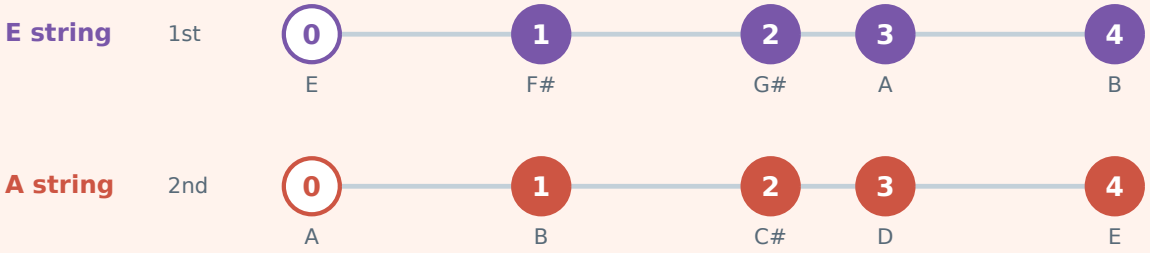
Find finger 1, then place 2 and 3. Listen after each note, release tension and repeat. Do not squeeze the whole hand to bring two fingers closer.

These are spacing guides, not millimeter templates. Violin size, hand shape and position change the actual distances.

Source: Original pp. 16-17.

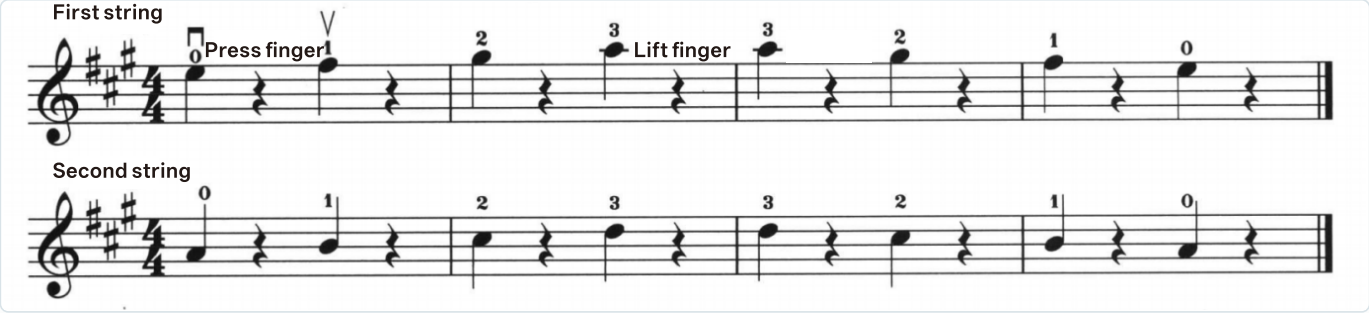
A major: start on A and E

Three sharps: F#, C# and G#. On the A and E strings, fingers 2 and 3 are close together.



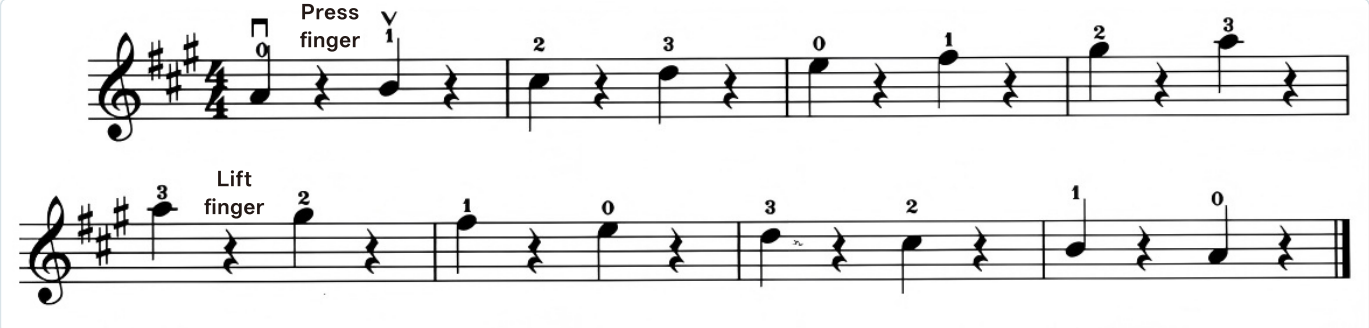
Pitch-spacing guide, not a measured fingerboard. 0 = open string. Close fingers are a half step apart.

Prepare each finger during the rest



Press or lift a finger during each rest, as shown. Practice the E and A strings separately. Keep the wrist natural and listen for a stable pitch.

Build the A major scale

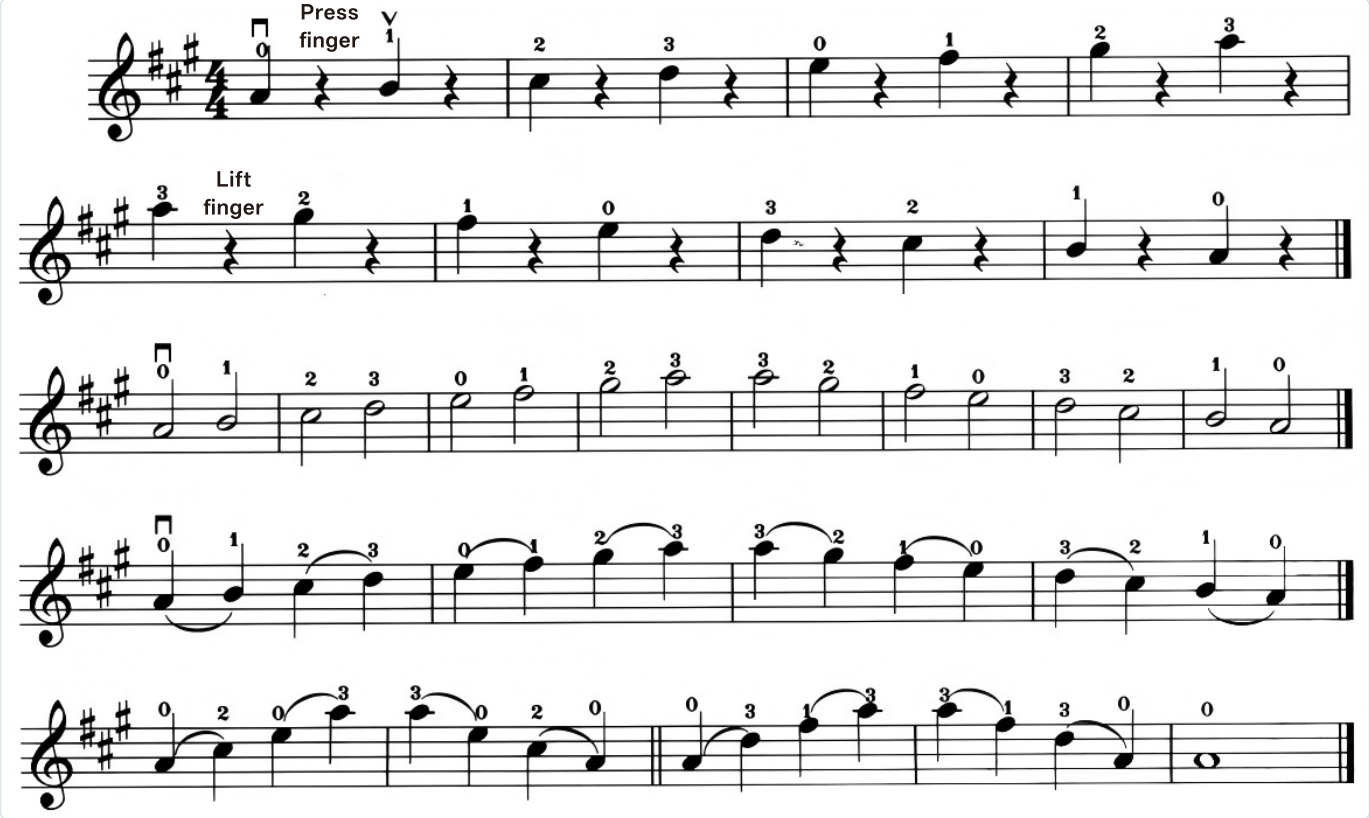


Start with the first two lines. Continue with the full scale on page 9 and Twinkle on page 10.

Source: Original pp. 20-21.

One scale, three ways to practice

Use the familiar A major scale so you can give more attention to the right hand.



Follow the music from simple to harder

1. **Lines 1-2: notes and rests**

   Prepare the next finger during the rest. Have it settled before the sound begins.

2. **Line 3: separate half notes**

   Two beats per note, one note per bow. Change direction calmly and keep strokes even.

3. **Lines 4-5: slurs and arpeggios**

   Group notes as marked. Keep every note clear and adjust the arm smoothly at string changes.

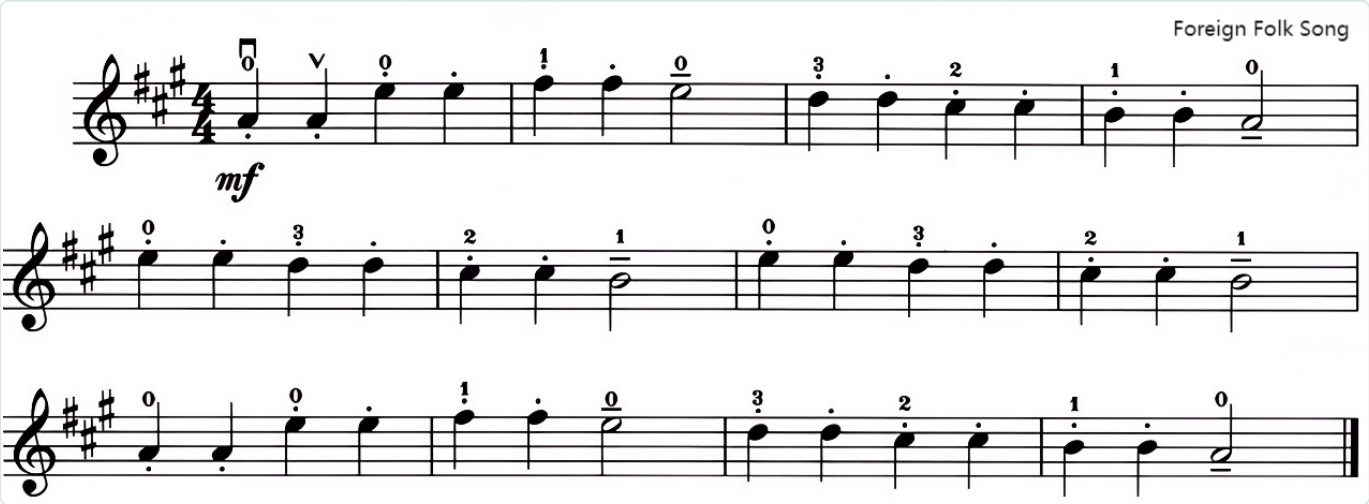
Next, try Twinkle on the following page and notice whether bow and string changes feel easier.

Source: Original p. 21; added practice sequence.

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star

A familiar melody / Labeled as a folk song in the original book

A major | 4/4 meter | First position



Three small tasks for the whole tune

1 Sing the tune and count

Learn each phrase by singing. Give half notes two full beats; do not hurry into the next bar.

2 Find the string, then the finger

Identify A or E, then use fingers 0-3 as marked. Remember C# and F#.

3 Follow the bow directions

Start slowly, one note per bow. Dots ask for short, clear notes. Keep the wrist flexible.

Today's goal

Play through slowly with accurate note lengths and calm string changes. Sing one phrase, then play it; this makes problems easier to hear than restarting the whole tune.

Source: Original p. 21; added practice steps.